

PERSONAL CONNECTION: DISPUTING A FEE

Do you hate confrontation? I used to be terrified of it. A bank could charge me whatever fees they wanted, and I would just smile and go along with it. Disputing a charge, asking for money back, or demanding basic human decency used to be my nightmare. Now, I've realized if you do not take a stand, you are going to be taken advantage of.

I recently had a dispute with the traditional bank I used at the time about their monthly maintenance fee, which is a totally bogus fee. To make matters worse, nearly all bank branches were closed because of the COVID-19 pandemic. I tried to call this big, impersonal bank multiple times and was put on hold for what felt like an insufferable eternity each time.

When I finally got through to someone, I pleaded my case, emphasizing that I always kept a positive balance and that I had been a member for many years. But because I was only using that bank for a backup checking account and kept a relatively low balance, they did not care. This finally made the choice simple for me: I could either go to a bank that charged no maintenance fees and provided outstanding customer service, or I could stay in the hellscape that was my traditional bank.

You should do the same. Even if the fee is \$10 per month, that adds up to \$120 per year! And, most importantly, you probably do not have to pay it. Banking does not have to be a nightmare; if you are unsatisfied with your bank and feel you are being mistreated, get another bank.